

# Baseball

Baseball is played in more than 100 countries around the world, including China, Japan, Venezuela, and Cuba. However, the game is often mostly closely associated with the USA, where it is one of the most popular sports.

## THE GAME

Two teams take it in turns to bat and field. The batting team tries to score "runs" by hitting the ball and then running around four bases. The fielding team tries to get the batting team "out" (stop it scoring runs). Three "outs" ends the inning and the team with the most runs after nine innings wins.



NO TIME RESTRICTION



9 TURNS (INNINGS) EACH, PLUS EXTRA IF SCORE IS TIED



2 TEAMS OF 9 PLAYERS

## EQUIPMENT

The most essential equipment for a game of baseball is, of course, the bat and the ball. As the ball can travel at speeds of up to 160 km/h (100 mph), some safety gear is also required.

### BALL

A baseball has a tough rubber and cork core, surrounded by red cotton wool and covered with two strips of leather.



Red stitching

7.5 cm (3 in)

### CATCHER'S MASK

Face and head protection is essential for catchers. Batters also wear helmets to protect their heads.

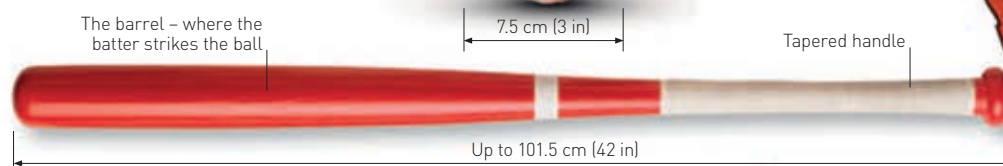


### GLOVES

Fielders wear a large, padded leather glove to make it easier and safer to catch the ball. The catcher also has a special mitt.

### BAT

Professional bats are made from wood and usually weigh up to 1 kg (2.2 lb).



The barrel – where the batter strikes the ball

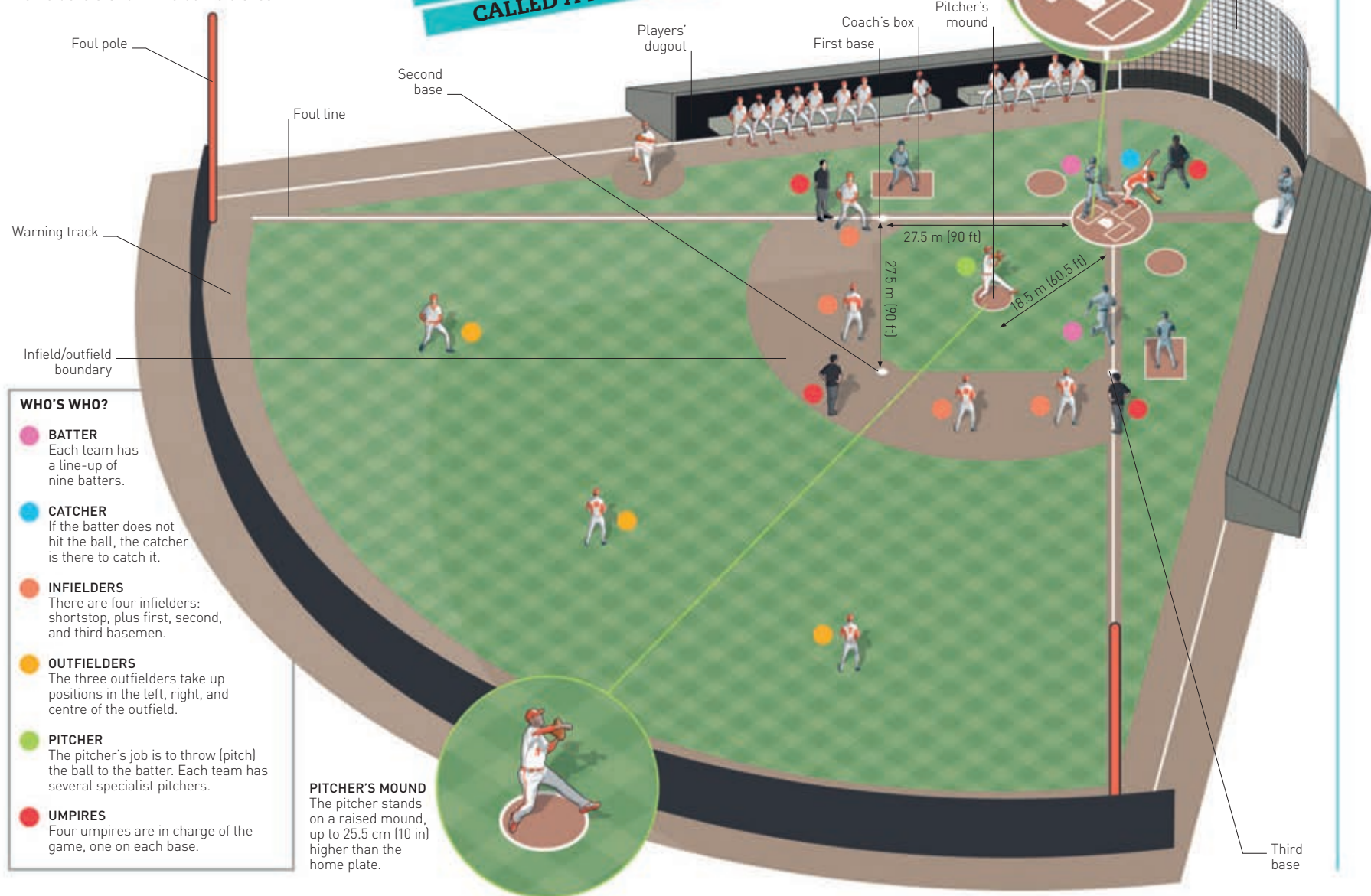
Tapered handle

Up to 101.5 cm (42 in)

## THE FIELD

The playing area is divided into the infield and the outfield. The infield is also known as the "diamond" and is where the batter, pitcher, and catcher all stand. It also contains the four bases and some fielders. The rest of the fielders stand in the outfield area.

**IF A BATTER HITS THE BALL SO FAR THAT HE OR SHE CAN RUN AROUND ALL THE BASES IN ONE GO, IT IS CALLED A HOME RUN**



### WHO'S WHO?

#### BATTER

Each team has a line-up of nine batters.

#### CATCHER

If the batter does not hit the ball, the catcher is there to catch it.

#### INFELDERS

There are four infielders: shortstop, plus first, second, and third basemen.

#### OUTFIELDERS

The three outfielders take up positions in the left, right, and centre of the outfield.

#### PITCHER

The pitcher's job is to throw (pitch) the ball to the batter. Each team has several specialist pitchers.

#### UMPIRES

Four umpires are in charge of the game, one on each base.

### PITCHER'S MOUND

The pitcher stands on a raised mound, up to 25.5 cm (10 in) higher than the home plate.